

DS2444A — Your Part: How To Fill It Out

A plain-language, question-by-question guide to the part of the disability application you complete yourself.

How to use this guide

This walks you through the DS2444A, the part of the disability application **you** fill out. Your doctor fills out the other part (DS2444B). We go question by question, in plain words, with an example of how to answer. This is a companion to the accessible fillable copy. The official form lives at dia.alberta.ca. If you get stuck, the Alberta Supports Contact Centre is 1-877-644-9992.

The one rule that saves people the most trouble

Tell the truth and tell all of it. Leaving something out that is found later does far more damage than the thing itself. Many assets and some income do not count against you, so list them and let the rules do their job. When a box is too small for the truth, write “see attached” and add a page.

Gather these before you start

- Photo ID, your Social Insurance Number, and your Personal Health Number.
- The last 12 months of statements for every bank and investment account (they will ask).
- Your 3 most recent pay stubs, if you work at all.
- Papers for any other income: CPP, CPP-D, EI, insurance, support payments.
- Papers for assets: vehicle, home, life insurance with a cash value, savings plans.

Your Situation (top of the form — read this first)

These questions can save you from filling out the whole application. Answer them truthfully before anything else.

Palliative or terminal illness?

If a medical professional has told you your illness is terminal, or you are in palliative care, check **Yes**. This is one of the groups that stays on AISH. Flag it clearly.

Living in, or approved and waiting for, a care facility or continuing care?

If yes, and a professional has assessed you as needing permanent placement, check **Yes** to both. Continuing care is also a group that stays on AISH.

“Skip Income & Asset — I get Income Support”

Only check this if you currently receive Income Support from the Government of Alberta. If you do, you can skip the money sections.

“Stopped AISH or ADAP less than two years ago, condition unchanged”

If this is you, the form tells you to contact an Alberta Supports office instead of filling out the whole thing. That can be a faster door. Worth a phone call first.

If none of those apply, check **None of the above** and complete the full application below.

Information About You (Q1–Q11)

Q1. Have you had AISH or ADAP in the last 24 months?

If your file was moved to ADAP on July 2, 2026, check the first box: **“Yes — my file was transitioned to ADAP as of July 2, 2026.”** This tells them you are a current client asking to be reassessed for AISH, not a brand-new applicant.

Q2. Waiting on an earlier AISH decision and wondering if you should reapply now?

Answer truthfully. If you already have an application in progress, say **Yes** so they do not treat this as a duplicate. There is no penalty for being in the queue. Reapplying does not cancel or reset anything you have already filed.

Q3. Are you receiving Income Support right now?

Yes or No. If yes, remember you can skip the Income and Asset sections.

Q4–Q6. Residency and status

Q4: are you an Alberta resident (Yes/No). Q5: did you immigrate or are you a foreign national. Q6: check your status — Canadian citizen, permanent resident, or sponsored immigrant. If sponsored, add the start and end dates and include your Record of Landing.

Q7. Your living situation

Check the one box that fits: rent, own, public or social housing, live with relatives, shelter, continuing care home, group home, no fixed address, or an institution. Pick the closest match. If you live somewhere unusual, check the nearest box and add a note.

Q8–Q9. Spouse or partner

Check your marital status. If you are married or living with a partner, fill in their details and say whether they receive AISH, ADAP, or Income Support. “Partner” includes a common-law relationship, so answer for how you really live.

Q10. Dependent children

If you have children who depend on you, list each one with their birth date, whether they live with you, and if they are 18 or 19, whether they are still in high school. Run out of room? Attach a page.

Q11. Trustee or Power of Attorney

If someone is legally acting for you — a trustee, or someone with Power of Attorney — put their name, phone, and address here. If a family member is only *helping* you fill this out but has no legal role, that is not a trustee; you can name them later as a contact person instead (see Consents).

Employment History (Q12–Q21) — the section that matters most

Read this before you answer the work questions

This is where an application is quietly won or lost. The aim is not to prove you never work. It is to show the truth: that you cannot **reliably sustain** work. Willing but unable is a real and common answer. Doing a little, at great cost, is evidence of how hard work is for you — not proof that you are fine.

Q12. Did you use any employment services or supports?

Yes or No. If yes, list what was recommended and what you tried (for example, DRES or a vocational program). If no, explain plainly — for example: “My condition has prevented me from taking part in employment programming.”

Q13. Are you willing to work if given the opportunity?

This asks about **willingness**, not ability. Most people want to work, and answering **Yes** is truthful for most of us. Saying yes does not hurt you, because willingness is not the test. Whether you can *sustain* work is the test, and that belongs in Q15 and in your doctor’s report. Do not talk yourself into a “No” you do not mean; answer as it is true for you and put the *can’t* where it belongs.

Q14. What steps have you taken to find work compatible with your disability?

Describe what you have tried, if anything, and be truthful if the answer is very little because of your health. Example: “I have looked for work I could do from home on my better days, but my symptoms are too unpredictable to commit to a schedule.”

Q15. Share how your disability affects your ability to work (marked optional — do not skip it)

This box is labelled optional. Treat it as the most important thing on your part of the form. This is your one open space to describe, in your own words, why reliable work is not possible for you. Use the pieces below that are true for you.

COPY / PASTE — EDIT EVERY BRACKET TO YOUR OWN TRUTH

My disability affects my ability to work in the following ways:

When my capacity depends on someone else: I can do tasks when a person is beside me directing me step by step, but on my own I cannot reliably start, organize, or finish what a job needs. Without that constant support, I cannot hold the work.

When your condition is unpredictable: My condition flares without warning. There are [days / weeks] I cannot leave home or function, and I cannot know in advance which days those will be. I cannot promise an employer that I will show up.

When you have tried to work: I have tried to work by [taking pain medication to get through / working from home on good days]. The days I work leave me [unable to function for days after]. The work cost me more than it gave, and I could not keep it up.

Everyday functioning: Day to day I struggle with [preparing meals / keeping appointments / managing medication / focus beyond [X] minutes]. These are not rare bad days. This is my ordinary week.

Use only the lines that are true for you. Change every bracket. This is your own account of your own life — write it in your voice.

Q16. Are you currently employed?

Yes or No, truthfully. If you do a small amount of work, say Yes and describe it truthfully in the next questions. A little work does not disqualify you.

Q17–Q21. Past and current jobs

List your employers, your role and duties (Q18), and your average hours per week (Q19). For seasonal, casual, or on-leave work, explain the arrangement and how often you worked in practice (Q20). For “reason for leaving” (Q21), if your health ended the job, check **Medical condition**. Do not soften it to “quit” if the real reason was your disability.

Education and Training (Q22–Q27)

These are quick. Check your highest level of school (Q22) and any training completed (Q23). Q24 asks what steps you have taken to find training that fits your disability — answer truthfully, even if the answer is that your health has not allowed it. Q25–Q27 ask if you are studying now or plan to; answer as it stands for you. There is no wrong answer here, and wanting to learn does not count against your disability claim.

Income (Q28–Q45)

Report every kind of income you and your partner get, with the average monthly amount, and attach the papers. Go line by line and check Yes or No for each. A few worth naming:

- Q28 Employment: attach your 3 most recent pay stubs.
- Q31 Canada Disability Benefit (CDB): report it if you get it.
- Q32 CPP / Q33 OAS / Q34 insurance / Q35 pension: report all of them.
- Q43 Other income: anything not already listed — say what and how much.
- Q44 Special payments in the last 12 months: a gift, inheritance, a sale, or accident or criminal-injury compensation. Report it even though it feels like a one-off.
- Q45 Have you applied for the DTC or CDB? Answer Yes or No.

Assets (Q46–Q66)

Report everything — exempt does not mean hidden

Fill in the value of anything you own. Many of these do **not** reduce your benefit, but you still have to list them. On the form, the items marked with a star are exempt: your **LIRA (Q51)**, **RDSP (Q52)**, and **home / principal residence (Q62)**. A vehicle adapted for your disability (Q59) may also be exempt. List it, mark the value, and let the exemption apply. Hiding an exempt asset turns something harmless into a problem.

Work down the list: bank accounts, cash, GICs, RRSP/RRIF, TFSA, stocks, trusts, life insurance cash value, vehicles, property, business. If it does not apply to you, leave it. If it does, put the value and attach documentation.

Declaration and Consents (the signatures)

Sign in every place that applies to you. If a trustee, guardian, or attorney is acting for you, they sign in their own line. A few notes on the consents so nothing surprises you:

- AISH / ADAP consent: lets them gather what they need to check your eligibility.
- Canada Revenue Agency consent: lets them pull your tax information. This is normal and expected.
- CPP-D consent: AISH requires you to use all income available to you, and treats CPP-D as one of those. Signing agrees to let CPP-D decide if you qualify. This is standard — not a trick.
- Contact person: if you want a trusted person or our campaign contact to be able to talk to AISH about your file, name them in the box provided.

Then check every page one more time, make sure each signature and date is in place, and keep a full dated copy of everything before you send it. Your copy is the start of your evidence file.

If it feels like a mountain

You do not have to climb it alone. Bring the question that is stuck to the group and we will take it apart one piece at a time. That is what we are here for.